Mei Chai

Product Designer · AI-Native Products & Design Systems

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PROFILE

Product designer with 6+ years of experience in UX design and user research, specialising in AI-native products and agentic workflows with human-in-the-loop control. Led UX across three AI products as Founding Designer (ConnectNova, JobNova, CrackInterview), combining design systems in Figma and code, data-informed iteration and production delivery with AI-assisted development. Also rebuilt a wholesale distributor's operations on one source of truth, including an AI procurement agent now in use.

CORE SKILLS

Product design: Problem framing, complex flows, user flows, information architecture, interaction design, web and mobile apps, accessibility (WCAG 2.2)
Design systems: Figma components, variants and variables; design tokens, reusable patterns, component guidelines
AI product design: Agentic workflow, human review, user controls, conversational UX, AI tools for prototyping
Research and data: Interviews, visual research, journey mapping, NPS, product metrics, PostHog funnels, heatmaps, session recordings, A/B testing
Prototyping and build: AI tools: Claude Code, Codex, Figma Make; React and SwiftUI front-end; code review
Collaboration: Developer handoff, QA and release QA, working in agile sprints with product managers and engineers, mentoring

FREELANCE

Freelance Product Designer Jun 2026 - Present

DEF Beauty, client project

- Rebuilt procurement as one source of truth, then designed an AI procurement agent, now in use, that proposes purchase plans with visible evidence and deterministic quantities and stops for human approval before any supplier or financial commitment; a purchase plan that took 30 minutes to 2 hours across suppliers now takes 5 to 10 minutes, and three staff members use it daily.
- Connected the WeChat mini-program storefront to the ERP, now live: orders that 4 to 5 salespeople used to key in by hand, 40 to 70 a day, as part of picking, entry and packing that took about two-thirds of their day, now arrive without re-entry, and customers order against real ERP stock, prices and delivery costs, so stockouts after ordering have almost disappeared.
- Investigated recurring order errors, traced them to fragmented data and delivered a wholesale order-management rebuild, reducing the ordering flow from 5 steps to 3. In a one-week sample about a month after launch, 86% of orders were placed by customers themselves through the mini-program; order errors almost disappeared and customer back-and-forth dropped, freeing salespeople to develop and maintain customer accounts.
- Designed role-based workflows for sales, procurement, warehouse and finance, and delivered the platform using AI-assisted development.
- Audited the operations app against WCAG 2.2 A/AA across 17 screens and dialogs with axe-core, addressing findings through component and token changes.

EXPERIENCE

Founding Designer (Remote) | Liba Space Nov 2024 - Jun 2026

- Designed JobNova's Auto Apply agent controls (qualifying criteria, approval settings, pause and revoke); 2,700+ users enabled it, about 1,300 of them paying, and by June 2026 it had submitted roughly 40k applications with a 4.1% interview-invitation rate, detected from email.
- Designed voice-based interview flows and a visual feedback dashboard for CrackInterview.
- Designed ConnectNova's candidate collection through a Chrome extension inside LinkedIn, AI-assisted ranking with editable criteria, and human review; the platform ranks batches of approximately 500 candidates in 5 to 10 minutes, against an estimated 2 to 5 hours of manual screening, and was tested by 70+ beta users.
- Designed and implemented ConnectNova's Outreach workflow in one week, covering branches, failure states and LinkedIn's limit of about 20 messages a day; tracked responses (connection accepted or message replied) reached 40%+; refined message editing based on post-launch behavior observed in PostHog.
- Redesigned JobNova onboarding from a single screen to a step-by-step flow; shipped the revision after a one-week PostHog A/B test with 100+ users raised completion from 73% to 96%.

- Built coded tokens and components for ConnectNova and Figma libraries for JobNova and CrackInterview, supporting consistent interfaces and component reuse by engineers after taking ownership of front-end delivery; design review findings for inconsistent styling dropped sharply, and the same component no longer appeared in different styles.
- Created Design Lab to manage design documentation, release reviews, testing and iteration as design work moved into code and AI-assisted development.
- Mentored two design interns for six months each, helping them progress from step-by-step guidance to independent design, team presentations and delivery.

User Research Specialist | Beijing Smart Walnut Education Jun 2020 - Jun 2022

- Led persona, journey and NPS research that informed product priorities and brand strategy, contributing to a 15% increase in user engagement.
- Translated research on parents' purchase priorities into product improvements, contributing to a 30% increase in sales.

UX Designer | Sohu Inc. Oct 2017 - Jun 2020

NASDAQ-listed Chinese internet company

- Independently conceived, designed and launched Sohu Moke, a long-form writing tool that turns long text-and-image posts into up to nine images, so they can be published on platforms with character limits such as Weibo, WeChat Moments and the Sohu News client; reached 3,000+ daily active users two months after launch. Defined interaction standards used across product teams.
- Designed interactions for the chat (one-to-one and group) and feed (images, text, video and live streaming) modules of Sohu's social app Huyou (狐友), including conversation management and multimedia messaging.

SIDE PROJECTS

Mono | Side project, web (live) 2026

- Designed and built Mono, a personal-finance agent on the A2UI protocol: LangChain routes each request and the agent composes a declarative A2UI spec from a registry of supported components instead of replying in plain text.
- Validated each spec and rendered it with product-owned React components; balances and records come from product services, and transactions save only after the user reviews an editable preview.

MemQ | Side project, iOS (App Store) 2026

- Designed, built and launched MemQ, an iOS study app that turns questions into AI-generated knowledge cards reviewed with spaced repetition (SwiftUI, Supabase, LLM workflow).
- Went from 8 user interviews to an App Store release in about 8 weeks; TestFlight sessions showed card creation was the drop-off point, so AI generation became the primary creation path.

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

MSc, Digital and Interaction Design | Politecnico di Milano | 2022 - 2025
BEng (Equivalent) | Jilin University | 2017
English (Fluent) | Italian (Beginner) | Chinese (Mandarin, Native)